AWS Cloud Institute Guide:
Building Your Digital Portfolio & Project Repository

Why a Digital Portfolio?

Your digital portfolio is your personal brand hub. It is a way to showcase your projects, skills, and learning journey to employers, one that goes beyond just your resume. It allows hiring managers (both technical and non-technical) to see what you're capable of building and why it matters.

Instructor Pro Tip: Start with one thing you know you can build today. That's enough. Just start. - *Ava*

Step 1: Get Started with a Simple Template

Free Template Sites:

Avoid complex themes – here are some great ones to get you started!

- HTML5 UP: https://html5up.net/
- GitHub: https://github.com/
- Bitbucket: https://bitbucket.org/

Basic Tools You'll Need:

- A code editor like **VS Code**
- A browser to test your site locally
- A foundational understanding of HTML/CSS
    - Great beginner-friendly site: W3Schools

Step 2: Customize Your Site

What to Do:

- Download your template as a .zip file and extract it
- Open it in VS Code and explore the structure (HTML, images, CSS, etc.)
- Replace placeholder text with your **bio, projects, images,** and **skills**
- Test locally: Open index.html in a browser to view updates as you make changes

Step 3: Hosting Options

Three recommended hosting options:

- GitHub Pages – *Free and simple*
- AWS S3 + CloudFront – *Great for showcasing AWS skills*
- AWS Amplify – *Supports full-stack apps with CI/CD*

Instructor Pro Tip: Ava and Errio recommend starting with GitHub Pages for ease and upgrading to S3 or Amplify as you gain confidence.

Tips for Building Strong Portfolios:

- Start with one project to avoid being overwhelmed
- Your site is always a Work in Progress (WIP) – don't wait for perfection!
- Focus on what you understand and can explain confidently
- Be mindful of AWS costs. You can use Free Tier or serverless options (e.g., Lambda)
- Add architecture diagrams and use Draw.io to incorporate visuals into your portfolio to showcase your thinking and process.
- If possible, include a short demo video or screencast

What to Include:

- **Intro/About Me:** Who you are, what you're learning, your tech stack
- **Projects:** Highlight a few key projects with:
  - Architecture overview
  - Goals and outcomes
  - Links to code repositories (GitHub, Bitbucket)
- **Certifications:** Add AWS certs and progress
- **Contact Info:** LinkedIn, GitHub, optional contact form

Bonus Resources:

- Full Portfolio Tutorial on YouTube: How to Create a Portfolio Website for FREE
- PartyRock (Free AI Tool): https://partyrock.aws/home
- Diagram Tool: https://draw.io/
- AWS Prescriptive Guidance (project ideas): https://aws.amazon.com/prescriptive-guidance/
- GitHub Template Repositories: https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/creating-and-managing-repositories/creating-a-template-repository
- Blog tutorial: Building a Free Blog with GitHub Pages in Minutes

Instructor Pro Tip: Focus on the project first, then build the HTML around it. Let the content drive the portfolio. – *Errio*

Examples from ACI Instructors:

- Ava's Portfolio: View Site | Ava's YouTube: @HeadintheClouds
- Errio's Portfolio: View Site | Errio's YouTube: @Cloud Coach Errio